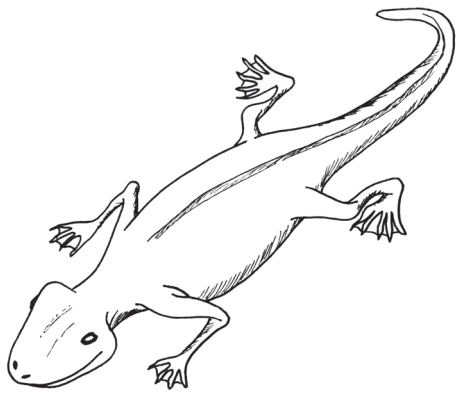
Giant amphibians

The **Mesozoic era** was the age of dinosaurs. Dinosaurs roamed Australia then, as well as some strange **amphibians**.

☞ **1** Use the phrases below to write a paragraph about a fossil of a giant prehistoric amphibian from the Mesozoic era that was found in Australia.

- jawbone discovered on a Victorian beach in 1990 by scientist Mike Cleeland
- lived in the swamps of prehistoric Australia
- an amphibian the size of a saltwater crocodile
- scientific name: *Koolasuchus cleelandi*
- ate fish and shellfish
- had a large, flat, broad head and a long body
- from the middle Cretaceous period, about 110–100 million years ago



The Mesozoic era is divided into three **periods**. The earliest is the **Triassic period** (230–195 million years ago), when the first mammals appeared. The next is called the **Jurassic period** (195–141 million years ago), when the world's first birds appeared. The last is the **Cretaceous period**, which ended around 65 million years ago.

☞ **2** Draw a timeline showing the three periods of the Mesozoic era. Show when birds, mammals and *Koolasuchus cleelandi* lived.

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